Nirmit Hitendra Dagli

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WORK EXPERIENCE

Founding Platform Engineer | Sidecoach Sports | Waco, TX **Aug 2026 – Present**

- **SRE & AI Ops:** Built Azure and GitHub monitoring from zero, plus an AI SRE agent that triages alerts, opens and updates Jira tickets, and proposes fixes using RAG, and an AI agent that audits the website for compliance.
- **Platform from Zero:** First infrastructure and security hire; built the Azure platform, GitHub CI/CD pipelines, and dev, staging, and prod environments from scratch, cutting monthly Azure spend 60%.
- **Security Program:** Moved the company from password-only access to enforced MFA, Intune-managed laptops, and layered server, container, and code security, raising CSPM Secure Score from 25% to 80%.
- **Change Management:** Set up a CAB-style change process in Jira integrated with GitHub and CI/CD, so every production change is ticketed, reviewed, and approved, including mandatory review of AI-generated code, giving the team an audit trail where none existed.
- **Compliance:** Own COPPA, FERPA, and PCI DSS (SAQ-A) compliance; launched SOC 2 readiness.

Research Assistant | Quinnipiac University | Hamden, CT **Sep 2024 – May 2026**

- **GPU Infrastructure & LLM Serving:** Ran Kubernetes GPU clusters (NVIDIA GPU Operator, Cilium) serving Llama 3, Mistral, Gemma, and DeepSeek with 4-bit quantization behind a process-isolated FastAPI server that eliminated CUDA out-of-memory crashes.
- **Inference Benchmarking:** Benchmarked vLLM, SGLang, and TensorRT-LLM on throughput, time-to-first-token, and GPU memory; compared on-prem GPUs, GCP L4, and AWS Bedrock for a RAG workload (30s → 15s → 10s avg latency), leading the lab to move inference to Bedrock.
- **HERO / HERO-S (SEET and IEEE ISAIA 2026):** Built workload-aware schedulers routing AI jobs across CPU, GPU, cloud, and edge by cost, energy, and latency (8×H100 cost model), cutting energy 72–98% vs. cloud-only.
- **Research Group & Publications:** Grew the research group from 2 to 10+ members across quantum computing, AI, and cybersecurity; authored 5 papers at IEEE, Springer, and MDPI venues.

Cloud and AI Engineer Intern | State Street | Boston, MA **Jun 2025 – Aug 2025**

- **Internal AI Assistant:** Only intern to ship an internal AI chatbot: Confluence RAG on Azure AI Foundry, delivered as a Microsoft Teams bot that answers access questions and helps developers write Terraform modules; secured approvals from the Confluence, Jira, Azure, and network teams.
- **Amazon Q Rollout:** Rolled out Amazon Q across 44 AWS accounts under bank-grade security with the Security, Compliance, and AWS enablement teams; trained engineers on Copilot and AI-assisted coding.
- **Developer Learning Platform:** Tested labs (HashiCorp Vault, Terraform) and produced video tutorials and lab material for an internal developer learning platform.

Senior Infrastructure Engineer (joined as Intern) | Zycus | Mumbai, India **Jan 2021 – Jun 2024**

- **Kubernetes & Multi-Cloud Platform:** Led the migration of 2,000+ workloads into 50+ Kubernetes clusters across AWS, Azure, GCP, and on-prem (EKS, AKS, GKE, Rancher, OpenShift), designed for security, scalability, and high availability with ArgoCD GitOps, Kyverno policies, and Velero backups; led a team of 5 standardizing Terraform, Ansible, and Jenkins provisioning, cutting provisioning time ~40%.
- **AI & Automation:** Built the company's first internal AI chatbot on Azure OpenAI (2024); automated recurring service requests through Jenkins pipelines, cutting tickets ~80% (about 50 to under 10 per week).
- **Observability & SRE:** Built observability end to end, from the network layer to application logs: Prometheus and Grafana for Kubernetes, ELK log pipelines that also fed SIEM detection, and Dynatrace APM; go-to incident responder.
- **Infrastructure & DNS:** Ran AWS infrastructure for production SaaS (EC2, EKS, Fargate, RDS, S3, ELB, Auto Scaling, CloudFront, CloudWatch); supported Oracle-to-PostgreSQL and MongoDB-to-Atlas migrations; managed DNS end to end across Route 53 and Akamai Edge DNS, including zones, records, and traffic routing.
- **Ransomware Recovery:** First responder in the company-wide recovery; restored 1,500+ servers across 7 environments (4 production) in 15 days, re-architected the network, and led 4 months of security hardening.
- **Networking & Security:** Designed the multi-account AWS strategy (separate accounts per environment and region); built Transit Gateway, VPC routing, Site-to-Site VPN, and Direct Connect; deployed 20 Palo Alto firewalls across 10 AWS environments and 5 on-prem FortiGates, and rolled out Zscaler (ZIA, ZPA), CrowdStrike, and CyberArk company-wide.
- **Backup, DR & Data Center:** After the ransomware incident, led the company's new Veeam backup, replication, and DR program across VMware, KVM/oVirt, and AWS; implemented NetApp SAN/NAS (NFS) with hot and cold storage tiers; ran data center operations (ESXi hosts, racking, cabling, iDRAC automation).

- **Linux Administration:** Started on the Linux team and became its go-to engineer; administered RHEL, CentOS, Ubuntu, and Kali servers, including LVM storage (PVs, VGs, LVs), SFTP and data servers, and day-to-day operational requests across 1,500+ servers.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

AI Infrastructure: vLLM, SGLang, TensorRT-LLM, AWS Bedrock, Azure AI Foundry, Azure OpenAI, Amazon Q, Hugging Face, LangChain, RAG
Kubernetes & Containers: Kubernetes (CKA, CKAD), Docker, Rancher, OpenShift, Kyverno, Velero, Cilium, NVIDIA GPU Operator
AWS: EC2, EKS, Fargate, S3, RDS, ELB, Auto Scaling, CloudFront, CloudWatch, IAM
Azure: Virtual Machines, AKS, Logic Apps, Entra ID, Intune, Azure Monitor
GCP: GKE, Compute Engine (L4 GPUs)
IaC & CI/CD: Terraform, Ansible, GitHub CI/CD, Jenkins, ArgoCD (GitOps), Git
Observability & SRE: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK, Dynatrace, SIEM, Jira
Linux & Systems: RHEL, CentOS, Ubuntu, Kali, Windows Server, LVM, VMware ESXi, KVM, oVirt, NetApp, Veeam, iDRAC
Networking & DNS: AWS Transit Gateway, VPC, Site-to-Site VPN, Direct Connect, Route 53, Akamai Edge DNS, Palo Alto, FortiGate, Zscaler
Security & Compliance: Zero Trust, Microsoft Defender, Cloudflare WAF, pfSense, CrowdStrike, CyberArk, OPA, SOC 2, PCI DSS, FERPA, COPPA
Languages: Python, Bash, YAML

EDUCATION

Quinnipiac University | Master of Science in Computer Science | GPA: 3.9/4.0 **May 2026**
University of Mumbai | Bachelor of Engineering in Information Technology **May 2020**

PUBLICATIONS & CERTIFICATIONS

- **Hybrid AI Scheduling & IoT Security:** HERO-S, **IEEE ISAIA** **2026**
- **Hybrid AI Scheduling:** HERO, **Springer SEET** **2026**
- **Sustainable AI:** Energy-Efficient AI for Foundation Models (coauthor), **Computers (MDPI)** **2026**
- **Generative AI:** SPARK – Smart Plug-and-Play AI Framework for RAG & Knowledge, **IEEE UEMCON** **Oct 2025**
- **Quantum Computing:** Grover's Algorithm for String Search and Its Practical Limits, **Springer SEET** **Aug 2025**
- LangChain for LLM Application Development, **DeepLearning.AI** **Jun 2025**
- Certified Kubernetes Application Developer – **CKAD** **Jan 2025**
- Certified Kubernetes Administrator – **CKA** **Mar 2024**
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate, **Amazon Web Services** **Nov 2022**